

Scientific Explanation Rubric

Use this rubric to evaluate the quality of your scientific explanation. Check the column that best describes your work in each category.

Criteria	4 – Excellent	3 – Proficient	2 – Developing	1 – Beginning
Evidence Support your explanation with relevant and sufficient evidence.	Uses specific, relevant, and sufficient evidence from data, readings, or investigations to fully support the explanation.	Uses relevant evidence that mostly supports the explanation.	Uses some evidence, but it is limited or not clearly related to the explanation.	Uses little to no relevant evidence to support the explanation.
Reasoning Explain how the evidence supports your claims.	Clearly explains how the evidence supports the claim using accurate scientific reasoning and concepts.	Explains how the evidence supports the claim with mostly accurate reasoning.	Attempts to explain the connection between evidence and claim, but reasoning is unclear or partially accurate.	Does not explain how the evidence supports the claim.
Organization Present your ideas in a clear and logical structure.	Ideas are clearly organized in a logical sequence that is easy to follow.	Ideas are organized in a mostly logical order that is generally easy to follow.	Ideas are present but the organization is unclear or sometimes hard to follow.	Ideas are disorganized or difficult to follow.
Format Follow instructions and use appropriate scientific conventions.	Follows all instructions, includes all required parts, and uses appropriate scientific conventions.	Follows most instructions, includes most required parts, and uses mostly appropriate conventions.	Follows some instructions but is missing parts or uses conventions inconsistently.	Does not follow instructions and does not use appropriate conventions.